Sprint 2 Review

Project: LevelUp Career Platform

Sprint: Sprint 2

Document: sprint2-review

1. Advisor Feedback — Areas to Improve from Sprint 1

Area to Improve — LLM Processing as Background Task
Advisor Comment: Change the dropdown LLM processing to run as a background task rather than blocking the UI.

Why This Matters: Running LLM calls synchronously slows the user experience and impacts scalability.

Sprint 2 Changes Made: Implemented initial LLM integration and began restructuring calls to support asynchronous/background processing.

Area to Improve — Database Hosting
Advisor Comment: Change the database from local hosting to remote hosting.

Why This Matters: Remote databases support deployment readiness and multi-user access.

Sprint 2 Changes Made: Migrated database to a remote instance for deployment and testing.

Area to Improve — Interview Design Process
Advisor Comment: Create a design process for interview features before development.

Why This Matters: Design-first development reduces rework and improves scalability.

Sprint 2 Changes Made: Conducted design planning for interview workflows and feedback logic.

Area to Improve — Resume & Cover Letter Optimization Alignment
Advisor Comment: Reuse resume optimization logic for cover letters.

Why This Matters: Reduces duplicated effort and ensures consistent AI output.

Sprint 2 Changes Made: Adapted resume optimization pipelines for cover letter generation.

Area to Improve — AI Response Caching
Advisor Comment: Cache AI responses to reduce API usage.

Why This Matters: Improves performance and reduces cost.

Sprint 2 Changes Made: Will implement strategies to reduce API usage

Area to Improve — AI-Assisted Debugging
Advisor Comment: Leverage AI tools for debugging.

Why This Matters: Improves development efficiency.

Sprint 2 Changes Made: Used AI tools to assist debugging and development tasks.

Area to Improve — Job Parsing Logic
Advisor Comment: Parse jobs using similar logic as resume parser.

Why This Matters: Ensures structured and consistent data extraction.

Sprint 2 Changes Made: Implemented job description parsing pipelines.

Area to Improve — Google Sign-In Issues
Advisor Comment: Fix Google authentication not working.

Why This Matters: Critical for user onboarding.

Sprint 2 Changes Made: Will fix this issue in the QA and debugging stage

Area to Improve — Password Reset Emails
Advisor Comment: Fix reset emails going to spam.

Why This Matters: Impacts account recovery.

Sprint 2 Changes Made: Will fix this issue in the QA and debugging stage

Area to Improve — Token & Context Monitoring
Advisor Comment: Monitor tokens and context length for cost.

Why This Matters: Prevents excessive API usage.

Sprint 2 Changes Made: Added token monitoring and prompt optimization.

Area to Improve — Technical Interview Experience
Advisor Comment: Support technical interviews like LeetCode and add prep resources.

Why This Matters: Improves realism and learning value.

Sprint 2 Changes Made: Expanded interview UI and added external resources.

2. Peer Feedback on Sprint 1 Demo

Insert screenshot(s) of peer feedback received on the forum regarding the Sprint 1 demo.

Feedback Item 1:

Gauri More

January 5 at 10:38 AM

Great presentation! I like your UI design, it looks very professional, something I would personally use for my resume and cover letter building.

One feedback I would give your group is as you polish your API for the AI suggestions, it would be a nice to have to show how the AI generates tailored suggestions for different roles or experience levels, so users can see the reasoning behind the feedback.

Other than that, great presentation and delivery. I look forward to seeing the final product of this project and wish you the best in the next sprint!

Reply

Consideration Status (Implemented / Partially / Deferred): Implemented

Explanation: You can upload the job description, and we extract important keywords that the model will use to optimize bullet points on your resume.

Related Sprint 2 Changes: Story 2.1 Added ability to add a job description

Feedback Item 2:

Rami Alaflak

January 6 at 8:29 AM

I really like the overall idea and the UI of this project. A smart resume tool that analyzes an uploaded resume and provides improvement suggestions is genuinely useful, and the interface feels clean and approachable, which is important for a tool aimed at job seekers. The planned addition of AI-generated cover letters in the next sprint also makes sense and fits naturally with the core concept.

One area I think could be improved in the future is reducing the amount of manual work required from the user. Currently, if the resume does not parse perfectly, the user is expected to manually edit the uploaded content. While it's good to offer this as an option, I think the default behavior should rely more heavily on AI-assisted correction, since manual editing can be tedious and time-consuming for users. The manual edit mode could still exist as a fallback for edge cases or users who want full control.

Similarly, the current interaction where the user must click each individual bullet point to see suggested changes feels a bit repetitive. A potential improvement would be to automatically apply or preview suggestions across all bullet points at once, and then present a fully updated version of the resume in a clear, side-by-side or highlighted format. This would make the experience more efficient and better align with the "smart" aspect of the product.

Overall, this is a strong and practical project with a polished UI and a clear real-world use case. With further automation and a focus on minimizing unnecessary user effort, it has the potential to become a very compelling tool.

Reply

Consideration Status (Implemented / Partially / Deferred): Partially Deferred

Explanation: To limit our token usage the user still must fix the resume if the parsing is messes up but the user can highlight multiple points rather than just individual points. The LLM will consider the bullet points properly.

Related Sprint 2 Changes: Story 2.1, added the ability to highlight multiple bullet points

Feedback Item 3:

Searan Kuganesan

January 6 at 6:01 PM

This was a well-executed presentation with a strong capstone focus. The project addresses a real and common problem, and the proposed solution feels genuinely usable in a professional job-search context. The interface is a standout aspect, as it is visually polished, easy to navigate, and aligns well with expectations for a resume and cover-letter tool.

One suggestion moving forward would be to further clarify how the AI arrives at its recommendations. Providing more context around how feedback changes based on different roles, industries, or experience levels would help users better interpret the suggestions and increase confidence in the system's outputs.

Overall, this is a solid and thoughtfully designed capstone with clear practical value. I'm interested to see how the functionality and AI-driven features develop in the next sprint.

Reply

Consideration Status (Implemented / Partially / Deferred): Implemented

Explanation: When adding a job description, the user can see what keywords the LLM is using to optimize your resume

Related Sprint 2 Changes: Story 2.1, added the ability to set a job description

Feedback Item 4:

Laith Kallab

January 6 at 6:27 PM

I found your AI-powered resume builder to be a very strong and timely project, especially given the current competitiveness of the job market for IT and engineering roles. The idea of tailoring resumes, cover letters, and interview preparation to specific job postings—rather than relying on a single generic resume—addresses a real and common pain point for job seekers, particularly new graduates who may be applying to a large number of positions. When developed thoughtfully, a tool like this can genuinely help users better highlight their skills and experiences, even when they have limited industry experience.

The user interface stood out as especially clean, intuitive, and professional, which makes the application approachable for users who may already feel overwhelmed by the job application process. Features such as Google sign-in significantly lower the barrier to entry, and the ability for users to manually edit resume sections alongside AI-generated suggestions adds an important layer of control and customization. The "optimize content" workflow, showing a clear before-and-after comparison of bullet points, was particularly effective in demonstrating the practical value of the AI and helping users understand how their content is being improved.

One potential area to consider moving forward is transparency and guidance around AI-generated content. Providing clearer cues or brief guidance encouraging users to review, verify, and personalize optimized text could help ensure resumes remain authentic and accurate. Additionally, as the system scales, aligning generated resumes with applicant tracking system (ATS) standards and maintaining consistent formatting across versions could further increase real-world usefulness.

Overall, this is a well-executed and highly relevant project with clear practical impact. With continued attention to usability, transparency, and industry alignment, it has strong potential to be a valuable tool for job seekers.

Reply

Consideration Status (Implemented / Partially / Deferred): Implemented / Partially Considered

Explanation: We agreed with the feedback regarding transparency and authenticity of AI-generated content. As our platform relies heavily on LLM optimization, it is important that users understand how their content is being modified and retain control over final outputs.

Additionally, the suggestion to align resumes with ATS (Applicant Tracking System) standards was valuable, as it directly impacts real-world usability and hiring outcomes.

Related Sprint 2 Changes: Ensured users must review and approve AI-generated edits before applying changes.

Feedback Item 5:

Noah Xu

January 7 at 8:37 PM

I really like the execution of your project so far! Extremely relevant given the current job market and definitely streamlines a lot of the tedious processes that we have to go through when applying for jobs. I also like the UI of your application a lot - it's very intuitive and easy to use. It seems your application is moving in a very good direction. Your group has a lot to show for sprint 1 and there's a clear goal going forward into sprint 2 as you finish development.

One main feature I would love to see you add in sprint 2 is the ability to create individual resumes tailored to individual job postings. You already mention doing this for cover letters, but it would be great to have your LLM also make minor changes to sentence structure and wording to better fit a desired company and its products.

Overall, great job with the product! Really impressed by your team and I'm looking forward to seeing what improvements you make in sprint 2 - especially around the interview prep component. Best of luck!

Reply

Consideration Status (Implemented / Partially / Deferred): Implemented

Explanation: When adding a job description the user can see what keywords the LLM is using to optimize your resume

Related Sprint 2 Changes: Story 2.1, added the ability to set a job description

Feedback Item 6:

Alexander Michael Vafaei

January 8 at 1:02 PM

Great work on your sprint 1 demo! I really like how polished and purpose-driven the UI already feels, it strikes a nice balance between professional and approachable, which fits the target audience well. As you move into sprint 2, one area that could really elevate the project is incorporating some analytics or progress-tracking features so users can see how their resumes improve over time. This kind of feedback loop could make the tool feel more interactive and rewarding to use. Overall, the project is off to a strong start with clear potential for real-world impact.

Reply

Consideration Status (Implemented / Partially / Deferred): Deferred

Explanation: Though the feedback is amazing and we'd love to implement something of sorts we just didn't have enough time to add more feature.

Related Sprint 2 Changes: N/A

Feedback Item 7:

Anna Liu

January 8 at 8:50 PM

I love the idea for the project! It's definitely a tool that I'd want to use and the UI looks polished for Sprint 1.

Having validation and security features already implemented is great and Firebase was a good choice with so many integrations already built in.

The only feedback I'd give would be to have the AI give more context for it's recommendations and (I may have missed this in the video, not sure) have an input for the type of jobs the user is interested in. Maybe an input for the specific listing, if you decide to take the app in that direction.

Overall great work!

Reply

Consideration Status (Implemented / Partially / Deferred): Implemented

Explanation: You can upload the job description, and we extract important keywords that the model will use to optimize bullet points on your resume.

Related Sprint 2 Changes: Story 2.1 Added ability to add a job description

Feedback Item 8:

Kwaku Asare

January 8 at 11:49 PM

I really like the idea behind this project. One piece of feedback I'd recommend is to have the option to upload the job description so that the AI bullet points are tailored to fit the description. I would also change the editing features from editing one bullet point at a time to having the option to AI edit the entire resume and provide suggested changes where the user just approves the changes. This would make it a little less time consuming especially.

Reply

Consideration Status (Implemented / Partially / Deferred): Implemented

Explanation: You can upload the job description, and we extract important keywords that the model will use to optimize bullet points on your resume. As for the entire resume you can highlight multiple bullet points not the entire resume

Related Sprint 2 Changes: Story 2.1 Added ability to add a job description and highlight multiple bullet points

Feedback Item 9:

Manav Sharma Sharma

January 10 at 11:59 PM

Really nice sprint 1 demo! It's honestly something I'd use. The interface feels polished and easy to follow, which matters a lot for a tool like this.

For improvements, I think it would help if the AI feedback came with a bit more context so it doesn't feel like random edits. Even a quick line like "here's what this change is doing" would go a long way. Also, the workflow could be faster if users didn't have to manually fix parsing issues or click into each bullet one at a time. Maybe you could let people preview or apply changes across the whole resume first, then approve what they want. Overall, really strong start.

Reply

Consideration Status (Implemented / Partially / Deferred): Partially Implemented

Explanation: There is a comparison window that shows your old bullet points and the new bullet point. Parsing yet still must be done manually though in future updates we will investigate options to fix this or change the parse to make it more robust. As for the bullet points you can select multiple bullet points not just singular points.

Related Sprint 2 Changes: Story 2.1 Added ability to highlight multiple bullet points